Face Mask

Category: **Safety & PPE** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 22 labs

Covers these lab items: Dust Mask; Dust Mask/Respirator; Dust Masks; Face mask; Face Mask (Reusable); Mask; Mask (Canvas Mask); Mask-Packet; Masks; Nose mask

What it is used for

A face mask provides a barrier against specified droplets, dust, or other airborne particles depending on its design and certification. Choose the correct mask for the hazard and wear it according to the manufacturer's instructions.

How to use

1. Check the mask type, packaging, condition, and expiry date where applicable.
2. Wash or sanitise hands before handling the mask.
3. Position the mask over the nose, mouth, and chin with the correct side facing outward.
4. Secure the straps or ties and adjust the nose piece if provided.
5. Check the fit and ensure there are no obvious gaps for the intended use.
6. Avoid touching the front surface while wearing the mask.
7. Remove the mask using its straps and dispose of or clean it as instructed.
8. Clean hands after removal and store reusable masks in a clean, dry place.

⚠ Safety

- Do not use damaged, wet, or contaminated masks.
- A loose-fitting face mask does not replace a required certified respirator for hazardous airborne exposure.
- Do not share used masks between people.
- Follow the mask's limitations and the site's infection-control or dust-control procedures.

Care & storage

- Replace single-use masks after use or when wet or soiled.
- Wash reusable masks as directed and store them clean and dry.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.